

## **RECORD OF PROCEEDINGS FOR THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE**

Office of City Clerk

March 23, 2026

The Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne convened in a special meeting on this date beginning at 7:38 p.m. in City Council Chambers for the purpose of collective labor bargaining with the Cheyenne Professional Fire Fighters, International Association of Fire Fighters, Local No. 279. Present were: MAYOR – Patrick Collins; COUNCIL MEMBERS – Dr. Aldrich, Dr. Emmons, Mr. Laybourn, Mr. Moody, Dr. Rinne, Mr. Segrave, Mr. White and Mr. Wolfe. Absent: Mr. Esquibel. Also present: Luisa Walsh, Deputy City Clerk; John Brodie, City Attorney; Amber Ash, Mayor’s Chief of Staff; Robin Lockman, City Treasurer and Deputy Chief of Administrative Services, Glenn Rodgers, Cheyenne Fire Rescue. The pledge of allegiance was recited.

Mayor Collins provided opening remarks regarding ongoing collective labor bargaining and acknowledged the concerns brought forth regarding salaries. He referenced a spreadsheet comparing the salaries of Local #279 to other departments throughout Wyoming and Colorado and emphasized we are comparable with other departments noting Cheyenne firefighters are offered reimbursement for education, whereas other departments do not offer this. Mayor Collins reviewed the City’s current compensation offer which includes maintaining the 3% COLA increase that was instituted in January, a 3% increase in base wages, an additional 3.5% increase to Captain and 4.75% to Battalion Chief to address compression, adjust probationary firefighter step to 5% less than firefighter step 4 and increase medical, longevity and specialty pay by 3%. Chris Thoms, President, Local #279, requested a recess to review the proposal at 7:45 p.m., and Union members vacated chambers to the HR conference room to caucus.

Mayor Collins reconvened the special session at 8:20 p.m. Mr. Thoms thanked the Mayor and City Council for their part in moving towards resolution. He stated that the Union was willing to move forward with the following framework: accept the 3% base pay increase with the understanding that it is a market base adjustment and not a COLA, an extension of the COLA sunset clause on page 34, Section 21 of the current Collective Labor Agreement to extend through the newly proposed agreement, and request City acceptance of the MERP (Medical Expense Reimbursement Plan) language as proposed by the Union. Mayor Collins reviewed the Vacation proposed language in Section 26 and advised that if the City and the Union can agree to the proposal, he would consider the MERP proposal. Mr. Thoms proposed amending the language to allow the four slots to be designated as either vacation or E.O.D. slots. Following discussion with Deputy Chief Rodgers, Mayor Collins confirmed mutual understanding of the vacation language, and both parties agreed to the revised terms including MERP language. Regarding the MERP, Mayor Collins indicated general agreement, with the exception that the City would not be required to contribute for firefighters not actively working or contributing. Mr. Thoms concurred, and both parties approved the MERP language as presented by Ms. Ash. Discussion then turned to Sick Leave, Section 27, with agreement to allow day personnel to utilize sick leave. For accruals under Vacations, Section 26 #8, both parties agreed that a full month must be worked to qualify. Additional discussion addressed military leave and emergency leave scheduling under Vacations, Section 26 #7 and #8. Mr. Thoms proposed allowing daytime personnel to convert benefit hours using a correction factor; however, Mayor Collins declined due to differences between daytime

and platoon shifts. Mr. Thoms subsequently withdrew the request. Mayor Collins and Mr. Thoms announced acceptance of all terms as discussed.

There being no further business to come before the governing body, the meeting was officially adjourned at 8:36 p.m.

Submitted by,

Luisa Walsh,  
Deputy City Clerk

This notice is available in alternative, accessible formats upon request.

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